

Travel thingamajigs

Affordable accessories for the techie traveller

70

Flint spark lighter - ₹159

Spotted @ DealExtreme
<http://bit.ly/FlintStick>



An essential camping tool that won't disappoint you. Matches can get soggy, lighters can run out of gas but this nifty thing will produce sparks as long as you don't submerge it, but if you get one that has magnesium then you can make sparks underwater too, though we wonder why you'd want to do that. With Diwali coming up, you might be able to make use of this quite a lot. Cosplay enthusiasts could rig one of these to a staff and go nuts, you could be Gandalf! Fair warning though, magnesium flint sticks are capable of producing sparks as hot as 3,100°C and if you ever manage to light the stick on fire, there is no stopping it. It burns even in the absence of oxygen. Dangerous? Yeah! Cool? Damn right!

71

USB lamp - ₹50

Spotted @ Lamington Rd.

This lamp is flexible and retains whatever way you shape it though it would have been a bit better if we could adjust its brightness, but for 50 bucks maybe that's a little bit more that we are asking for. Especially in hostels, if you want to give your roommate a rude waking, just adjust the lamp to hover right above your roommate's eyes and flick it on, this thing is so bright that your roommate's dream world will light up instantly. Oh what fun!

72

USB charger - ₹ 60

Spotted @ Lamington Rd.

This can charge most batteries in the market, and with adjustable clips form factor compatibility isn't an issue. Also, nearly all PMPs available today are capable of being charged via USB. The influx of many USB devices in the market does mean that you end up using all available ports on your computer for some peripheral or the other. Multiple variants of the charger are available on the street from ones that have just one outlet mimicking Apple's iPod charger to ones that have enough ports to support the entire city.



73

Soccer binoculars - ₹120

Spotted @ DealExtreme - <http://bit.ly/SoccerBinocs>

An innocently disguised pair of binoculars, this may seem silly but once it folds up into a key-chain, nobody is going to suspect you were up to something.

If you have a habit of being up to no good, then you might want to reduce the chances of getting caught. With these binoculars, you won't be able to spot the fuzz from miles away, after all it only provides 3x28 magnification, but it goes a long way into looking inconspicuous. When caught at a crime scene, you could dangle the key-chain and go, "Officer, do you really think I could have done this?"



74

Emergency glow sticks - ₹899

Spotted @ eBay.in - <http://bit.ly/GlowStik>

Glow sticks are uber cool, period. Weather you want to throw an impromptu rave party or if you like to accessorise. Then there is the option of using the fluid inside to tattoo your eyeballs if you wish, but once activated the glow will die out in a few hours. A bunch of these are an essential for your zombie survival kit. Drinking the fluid is unlikely to cause significant morbidity or mortality but as with any self-luminescent object, we'd advise caution.



75

Complete USB accessory travel kit - ₹1,259

Spotted @ GadgetsGuru - <http://bit.ly/usbTravelKit>

Deep breath. Here we go: Stereo earphones and microphone, multiple USB A to A, FireWire to six-pin, RJ11 cable, USB A/M to USB A/Male, USB A/M to USB B/Male connector, retractable USB mouse, four port hub, RJ45 to USB... ok, we've run out of breath and there are six other accessories to go in this USB swiss knife. Nuff said.



76

52 mm macro kit - ₹299

Spotted @ eBay.in - bit.ly/MacroKit

This kit gives you four lenses ranging from 1x to 10x. The drawbacks being that you'd have to get very close to the subject and your depth of field becomes very narrow even at the smallest aperture. So, if you are on a safari and want to photograph that magnificent nose of an African lion or the pointy horn of the white rhinoceros, then this isn't exactly the kit to vouch for.

